



A game of 3D playable virtual pool being rendered inside your browser in Real Time

`all_sites` and set it to `True`.

Unlike Direct2D, confirming if WebGL is working is a far more tangible experience. Go to http://o3d.googlecode.com/svn/trunk/samples_webgl/o3d-webgl-samples/pool.html. If you get to see a beautiful pool table as shown in the screenshot above then it works, else you'll get a mean looking error of the form saying No WebGL context found. Even in Firefox 3.x, you will find the options in `about:config`, but setting them won't matter and you will still not be able to run WebGL content. We leave you with a few more links to play with. This also includes one that runs *Quake* within your browser: http://www.nihilogic.dk/labs/worlds_of_webgl/ http://www.khronos.org/webgl/wiki/Demo_Repository. <http://code.google.com/p/quake2-gwt-port/import>.

Experiencing HTML5

A quick search on Google for HTML5 videos will give you examples in plenty. Go to www.youtube.com/html5 and you will be prompted to join the HTML5 program. If you're not already a part of it, you might need to sign in with your Google account for this.

Once done above, it will ensure that if any video can be presented in HTML5 format, it will be offered to you. Especially the higher definition videos. Search for a video using keywords. For example, trailers. In the browser's address bar, add `&webm=1` at the end of the URL. For example, http://www.youtube.com/results?search_query=trailers&aq=f&webm=1. Select your favourite video and it will display HTML5 webm in the toolbar of the video player.

Finally, we would like you to go to

<http://html5test.com/> and see your score for yourself. In our test runs, Firefox4 beta1 scored 199. Remember if you enable hardware acceleration as explained above, you should gain around 15 points, while



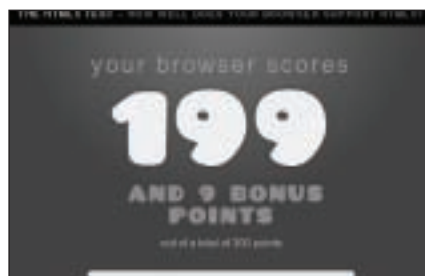
HTML5 Video in YouTube

Firefox 3.6 gave 139 and the webkit-based browser on our Symbian phone gave around 30.

Plugins and extensions

For most Firefox users, a primary reason to use the browser has always been the power to customise it with a choice of their favourite extensions by installing them from a vast repository. Developers have enhanced this part of the browser in two ways. One is an enhanced and more featureful new Add-on Manager. The Add-On Manager now opens in a tab instead of a Window and has been designed to make finding plug-ins practically effortless. Beta users can also grab an Add-On Compatibility Reporter to test their favourite add-ons for compatibility.

In addition to above, starting with Firefox 3.6.4 (partially) and with Firefox 4 Beta1 (almost completely), Firefox brings in a feature known as "Out-of-Process-Plugins" or OOPP that implies Flash, Java, QuickTime and similar platforms run their own separate process. So if they crash, they don't



Firefox4 score on Linux

bring down the whole Firefox window but only close the respective tab.

Other features

Layout

The new layout of Firefox, with the aim of maximising screen estate, especially on widescreen monitors with lower vertical resolution, has strong supporters as well as critics. First, it brings the tabs on top of the navigation (address) bar. This is present by default only in the Windows version of Firefox 4. Mac and Linux users will need to go to the View menu, select Toolbars from there and then Click on Tabs on Top to switch this UI feature.

Then comes the removal of the menu bar and merging it into one big button. This isn't available in the Linux flavour. Finally, you have the removal of the bookmarks menu into a tiny button right next to your address bar. Love it or hate it, this is what you get in the default bundle, though thankfully you can tweak it to your satisfaction.

Error console

Go to the Tools menu in and Click on Heads Up Display or Press `[Ctrl] + Shift + [K]` and you will be presented with tabbed interface enhanced error console aimed especially towards helping developers in debugging and improving compatibility. Entries are time stamped and categorised into DOM (for AJAX especially), Network, CSS, Exceptions, Errors, Info, Warnings and Log.

Awesomness bar

Introduced in Firefox 3, in the Firefox 4 version it also allows you to switch to an open URL by typing in the URL or the title of the page. This is immensely useful if you have several open tabs and want to switch to it without navigating through all the tabs. Whenever you feel like switching to an open tab, just type in the first few letters of the URL or the title of the page and you will be shown an option to switch to that open tab.

There are many more improvements like geo awareness, privacy fixes, JavaScript speed enhancements and like, so do remember to give the shiny new Firefox a spin. 